

A SUMMIT VALOR RESOURCE

THE OPERATIONS READINESS CHECKLIST



*25 questions every growing business
should ask before scaling*

SUMMIT VALOR

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Why operations readiness matters

Most businesses don't fail because of a weak offer or a soft market. They stall because the operations underneath the business were never built to carry more weight.

Growth exposes what's fragile. The founder who is still the bottleneck for every decision. The process that only works because one person remembers the steps. The system that was fine for ten clients and breaks at fifty.

This checklist gives you a fast, honest read on where your operations stand today across twelve areas — from leadership and systems to documentation, delegation, and business continuity.

HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST

- 01** Read each question and answer honestly — this is a private diagnostic, not a test.
- 02** Check the box only when the statement is consistently true today, not "in progress."
- 03** Total your checks at the end and find your score band on the final page.
- 04** Use your results to decide where to focus first — or where to bring in support.

LEADERSHIP

- ☐ I can take two full weeks away from the business without daily operational fires.
- ☐ Key decisions don't all require my personal sign-off.

SYSTEMS

- ☐ Our core workflows run the same way regardless of who executes them.
- ☐ We use a central system of record instead of scattered docs and chat threads.

DOCUMENTATION

- ☐ Our most critical processes are written down somewhere other than my head.
- ☐ A new hire could follow our documentation without shadowing someone first.

CLIENT OPERATIONS

- ☐ Client onboarding follows a repeatable, documented process.
- ☐ We have a defined process for client offboarding and handoff.

TEAM OPERATIONS

- ☐ Every team member has a clear, written description of their role.
- ☐ We have a standard onboarding process for new team members.

COMMUNICATION

- ☐ There is one clear channel of record for internal decisions — not scattered DMs.
- ☐ Meetings produce documented notes, owners, and deadlines.

TECHNOLOGY

- ☐ Our core tools are integrated rather than requiring manual double entry.
- ☐ We've audited our tech stack in the last 12 months for overlap or waste.

REPORTING

- ☐ We review a defined set of KPIs on a consistent weekly or monthly cadence.
- ☐ Reporting is generated from data, not manually assembled each time.

SOPS

- ☐ Our top five recurring tasks each have a written standard operating procedure.
- ☐ SOPs are stored centrally and kept up to date.

DELEGATION

- ☐ I have a clear view of which tasks only I should do versus what can be delegated.
- ☐ My team is empowered to make decisions without escalating everything to me.

CAPACITY

- ☐ We know our team's current capacity and when we're approaching its limits.
- ☐ We have a plan for scaling delivery before we take on more clients.

BUSINESS CONTINUITY

- ☐ The business could continue operating smoothly if I were unexpectedly unavailable.
- ☐ We have documented contingency plans for our most critical systems and vendors.
- ☐ We store passwords, access credentials, and key contacts somewhere shared and secure.

SCORE YOUR BUSINESS

What your score means

Count every box you checked across all twelve categories, then find your total below.

0–8

FOUNDATION STAGE

Your operations are running on founder memory and improvisation. This is normal at the earliest stage — but it will actively limit growth from here. Start with documentation and one core system.

9–16

BUILDING STAGE

Some structure exists, but it's inconsistent and still depends heavily on you. Focus on converting your best informal processes into written SOPs your team can run without you.

17–21

SCALING STAGE

Your operations can mostly support growth. The gaps that remain are the ones that will surface — and cost the most — the moment you add volume, headcount, or complexity.

22–25

OPTIMISED STAGE

Your business runs on systems, not memory. The opportunity now is refinement: sharper reporting, tighter capacity planning, and continuity plans that protect what you've built.

Know where you stand. Now build the plan to fix it.

A checklist tells you where the gaps are. A Summit Operations Blueprint tells you exactly how to close them — with a prioritised roadmap built around your business.

BOOK YOUR OPERATIONS BLUEPRINT

summitvalor.com/blueprint